

ATTITUDES OF GRATITUDE

Blue = PPT slide

Brown = Instructions to technician

TEXT: Psalm 92:1-2 (NKJV) *“It is good to give thanks to the Lord, to sing praises to Your name O Most High; to declare our lovingkindness in the morning, and your faithfulness every night.”*

INTRO: Good = Right, proper, correct!

Sing praises = Developing and maintaining the right attitude despite the circumstances!

Declare = Speaking by faith – Calling what is not as if it is!

Attitude is more of a decision than an activity. We cannot control what happens to us but we can control the attitude with which we DECIDE to confront such things.

According to Dictionary.com attitude = Manner, disposition, feeling - Tendency or orientation, especially of the mind.
Orientation = Position in relation to some benchmark.

In aeronautics the attitude of an aircraft is determined by its relationship to the ground.

When flying, the pilot has in front of him in the cockpit an “AI” or attitude indicator. The attitude indicator is an instrument used to inform the pilot of the orientation of the aircraft relative to Earth's horizon.

An aircraft can have three basic attitudes:
(PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME
WITH THE APPROPRIATE ATTITUDE
OF AN AIRCRAFT)

- When the centerline of the plane is parallel to the ground the plane is in a

- Level Attitude...** A level attitude covers more ground over the long haul...
- When the nose of the aircraft is above the horizon, it is called a **Nose High Attitude...** We have to get our nose up to get off the ground... If we keep our nose up long enough we will reach an altitude the aircraft cannot sustain...
 - If the nose of the aircraft is below the horizon the aircraft is in a **Nose Low Attitude...** At times we must get our nose down to land at a destination... (humility – “God blesses the humble and resists the proud”) If we keep our nose down too long we will crash...

While in flight, the pilot must monitor not just the plane's altitude but also the plane's attitude. If we are going to have an attitude of gratitude we must never be concerned with altitude only, but the attitude with which we are flying at that altitude!

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN, A PICTURE OF THREE AIRPLANES WITH ALL THREE ATTITUDES – LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)

Whether the nose is level, pointed up, or pointed down is going to make a world of difference to the pilot and any passengers he may have.

It is accurate to say, that the pilot must maintain vigilance concerning a plane's attitude, it's orientation to the horizon and ground, in order to stay on course and avoid catastrophe.

Thanksgiving is the perfect time for us to consider the goodness of God in our lives and to offer expressions of gratitude for His presence and provision. It is also a time for us to thank everyone who has contributed to the success of our lives.

Though Thanksgiving is a wonderful time we should learn to live our lives every day with attitudes of gratitude!

Dictionary.com say's Gratitude = Being grateful – Warmly appreciative of kindness or benefits received.

Even though an individual possesses an attitude of gratitude, they may experience:

- Turbulence...
- Headwinds...
- Delays...

...will arrive safely at the desired destination. (My definition of a good flight is that it landed – Landed at its destination)

An attitude of gratitude is God's will for each of His children. [1 Thessalonians 5:16-18 \(NKJV\)](#) ***"Rejoice always, pray without***

ceasing, in everything give thanks, for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus for you.”

CONCLUSION:

Listen to what Paul wrote while being held in custody at Rome, awaiting trial before the emperor. 1 Thessalonians 3:2-4 (NKJV)

“We sent Timothy, our brother and minister of God, and our fellow laborer in the gospel of Christ, to establish you and encourage you concerning your faith, that no one should be shaken by these afflictions; for you yourselves know that we are appointed to this. For in fact we told you before when we were with you that we would suffer tribulation, just as it has happened, and you know.”

Listen to what Paul wrote while he and Silas were imprisoned in Philippi for casting a demon out of a girl. Philippians 4:6-7

(NKJV) *“Be anxious for nothing, but in*

everything, by prayer and supplication, with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God; and the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and minds through Christ Jesus.” While in jail for the gospel, Paul gives us the following matrix for maintaining an attitude of gratitude:

- Don’t let the challenge rattle you... *“Anxious for nothing...”*
- Pray about everything... *“Let your requests be made known to God...”*
- Embrace the peace of God... *“The peace of God surpasses understanding...”*
- Maintain a level, nose up, or nose down attitude... *“guard your heart and mind...”*